

1] What is the use of the ALTER command in SQL?

Ans:

Use of the ALTER Command in SQL

Definition:

The ALTER command in SQL is used to modify an existing database object, such as a table. It allows you to change the structure of the table by adding, deleting, or modifying columns and constraints.

Common Uses of the ALTER Command:

1. Adding a New Column:

The ALTER command can be used to add new columns to an existing table.

```
ALTER TABLE table_name
```

```
ADD column_name datatype;
```

2. Modifying an Existing Column:

You can change the data type of an existing column or modify other properties like NULL or DEFAULT constraints.

```
ALTER TABLE table_name
```

```
MODIFY column_name new_datatype;
```

3. Dropping a Column:

You can remove a column from an existing table using the DROP COLUMN clause.

```
ALTER TABLE table_name  
DROP COLUMN column_name;
```

4. Renaming a Table:

You can rename an existing table using the RENAME clause (Note: syntax may vary by DBMS).

```
ALTER TABLE old_table_name  
RENAME TO new_table_name;
```

5. Adding or Dropping Constraints:

You can add or remove constraints like PRIMARY KEY, FOREIGN KEY, or CHECK using the ALTER command.

```
ALTER TABLE table_name  
ADD CONSTRAINT constraint_name constraint_type;
```

```
ALTER TABLE table_name  
DROP CONSTRAINT constraint_name;
```